KOLKATA THIS WEEKEND

Startup & Product Documentation

Everything happening in Kolkata, this weekend.

A city-first discovery platform that aggregates public events, experiences, meetups, workshops, nightlife, food events and local activities from the places people already publish them — then turns that fragmented information into one simple weekend feed.

PRODUCT Consumer discovery + local experiences	LAUNCH CITY Kolkata, West Bengal
CORE PROMISE Find something worth doing.	MODEL Aggregation + discovery + referrals

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THE IDEA

1. Executive Summary

Kolkata This Weekend is a city-first platform for discovering what is actually happening around Kolkata. It does not need to own or organize the events it lists. Instead, it becomes the discovery layer between local organizers and people looking for something to do.

The product solves a familiar problem: information about events is scattered across Instagram, ticketing platforms, community groups, cafés, clubs, colleges, studios, Facebook, Meetup and independent websites. Users should not have to search ten places to answer one question: “What can I do this weekend?”

North-star experience

Open the app → choose your city, day, budget and vibe → instantly see relevant plans → save/share → visit the original source or booking page.

Core positioning

• Not: another organizer-owned event marketplace.

• Instead: an independent discovery and aggregation layer for the city's weekend life.

• Long-term: a local “what's happening” engine that can expand city by city.

WHY THIS SHOULD EXIST

2. Problem Statement

Kolkata has a large and diverse offline ecosystem, but discovery is fragmented. An event may exist online without appearing in the same place as another event happening two kilometres away.

USER PROBLEM	ORGANIZER PROBLEM
I want to go out, but I don't know what's happening.	My event exists, but people outside my existing audience may never see it.
I have a budget/time/vibe constraint and want options quickly.	I have to promote across multiple channels.
Information is scattered and often inconsistent.	There is no neutral local discovery layer connecting demand to supply.

WHAT MAKES IT DIFFERENT

3. Product Thesis

The product should not compete on “having events.” It should compete on having the best answer to the user's intent.

Intent-first discovery

Users browse by “tonight”, “this Saturday”, budget, distance, category and vibe — not just by organizer.

Source-respecting aggregation

Every listing points back to the original organizer/source. The platform amplifies local creators instead of replacing them.

Curation over clutter

Quality, freshness, duplicate detection and useful metadata matter more than raw listing count.

Planning layer

Saved events can become a personal weekend plan, not just a list of bookmarks.

MVP → V2

4. Core Product Features

Feature	MVP purpose
Weekend Feed	A date-aware feed of things happening around Kolkata.
Categories	Music, workshops, food, theatre, comedy, sports, nightlife, community, family, culture and more.
Filters	Date, price, location, distance, category, free/paid and vibe.
Event Page	Clean summary with date, time, venue, price, description, source and original link.
Save / Wishlist	Users save events and build a personal shortlist.
Share	Create shareable event cards/links for WhatsApp and social media.
Submit an Event	Organizers submit an Instagram post, poster or event URL.
AI Extraction	Extract date, time, venue, price, category and source from submitted content.
Duplicate Detection	Merge repeated listings of the same event.
Freshness	Automatically flag expired or stale listings.

PRODUCT MOAT

5. The Signature Feature: Build My Weekend

A user should be able to describe their constraints in plain language instead of manually browsing dozens of listings.

Example prompt

“2 people · Saturday · ₹2,000 total · New Town · chill + food + something fun.”

The system returns a curated sequence such as café → workshop → dinner → live music, with estimated spend, distance and source links.

Potential inputs

- Number of people
- Budget
- Date / time window
- Area or travel radius
- Vibe
- Food preference
- Indoor / outdoor
- Free vs paid
- Accessibility / family-friendly preference

HOW THE PLATFORM GETS EVENTS

6. Data & Content Strategy

The platform should not depend on the founder manually entering every event. The content system can combine organizer submissions, public sources and editorial verification.

Source	Method	Priority
Organizer submission	URL/poster/form → AI extraction → review	Highest
Public event pages	Structured ingestion where permitted	High
Social discovery	Discover public posts and send organizers a claim/submit flow	High
Ticketing platforms	Link/reference to original listing	High
Local venues	Venue pages + recurring events	Medium
Community submissions	User-submitted event tips	Medium

Important: automated collection should respect platform terms, robots rules, copyright, privacy and API/licensing requirements. The product should prefer direct submissions and official/public links when possible.

FROM DISCOVERY TO ACTION

7. User Journey

01	**Open**	“Kolkata This Weekend”
02	**Choose**	This weekend / tonight / next weekend

03	**Refine**	Area + budget + vibe + category
04	**Discover**	Curated cards with useful context
05	**Save**	Build a shortlist or weekend plan
06	**Act**	Open organizer / booking source
07	**Share**	Send a plan to friends

RED × CREAM

8. Brand Direction

The visual identity should feel like a modern city magazine mixed with a social discovery product — warm, editorial and energetic rather than looking like a generic ticketing marketplace.

Element	Direction
Primary	#B51F2A — confident Kolkata red
Background	#FFF8EE — warm cream white
Text	#241C1C — near-black warm ink
Accent	#F7E3E1 — pale red cards
Typography	Distinctive geometric / editorial sans for headings; clean sans for body
Photography	Real Kolkata streets, cafés, venues, people and events
UI mood	Editorial cards, generous whitespace, strong red CTAs, subtle borders

WHY THIS CAN STILL WIN

9. Competitive Positioning

There are already event discovery, ticketing and local-content platforms. The opportunity is not to claim that event discovery is new; it is to create a sharper local product with a better user job-to-be-done.

Existing pattern	Typical strength	Kolkata This Weekend angle
Ticketing marketplace	Bookings + inventory	Discovery across sources, including non-ticketed events
Event directory	Large listing volume	Freshness, curation and weekend intent
Social media	Huge creator/event supply	Structured, searchable event information
Local editorial guide	Curated recommendations	Real-time event database + planning

HOW IT CAN MAKE MONEY

10. Monetization

Sponsored discovery

Venues, organizers and brands pay for clearly labeled promoted placements.

Affiliate / referral revenue

Earn a commission where ticketing, booking or partner programs support referrals.

Organizer premium

Optional paid tools for analytics, boosted distribution, profile pages and event insights.

Local partnerships

Tourism, cafés, malls, communities, colleges, lifestyle brands and city campaigns.

Future membership

A premium layer could offer curated plans, perks, discounts and priority experiences.

BUILD SMALL, VALIDATE FAST

11. MVP Scope

- Kolkata-only web app / PWA
- Weekend-first homepage
- Event feed with categories and filters
- Event detail pages
- Organizer submission form
- Admin moderation dashboard
- AI-assisted metadata extraction
- Duplicate detection
- Save / wishlist
- Shareable event URLs
- Original-source links
- Basic analytics: views, saves, outbound clicks

Do not build initially

- Native mobile apps
- Complex social profiles
- In-app chat

- Full ticketing infrastructure
- Payments
- Large-scale nationwide expansion

TECHNICAL FOUNDATION

12. Suggested Technology Architecture

Layer	Suggested approach
Frontend	Next.js / React + responsive PWA
Backend	Node.js / serverless API or equivalent
Database	PostgreSQL / Supabase
Search	Postgres full-text + optional vector search
AI	LLM for extraction, classification, summaries and deduplication
Maps	Google Maps / Mapbox depending on requirements and cost
Media	Object storage + image optimization
Admin	Protected moderation dashboard
Analytics	Privacy-conscious product analytics

KOLKATA-FIRST

13. Launch Strategy

Phase 1 — Seed

Start with 100–300 high-quality listings across a handful of categories. Prioritize freshness over volume.

Phase 2 — Organizer loop

Contact cafés, studios, communities, colleges, venues and event hosts. Make “Add your event” frictionless.

Phase 3 — Social loop

Create shareable “This Weekend in Kolkata” cards for Instagram and WhatsApp.

Phase 4 — Personalization

Learn from saves, clicks and filters to improve recommendations.

Phase 5 — Expand

Only after Kolkata has strong retention, repeat the playbook in another city.

WHAT TO MEASURE

14. Success Metrics

Metric	Why it matters
Weekly active users	Measures recurring city discovery demand.
Event detail CTR	Shows whether feed cards create interest.
Save rate	Indicates intent beyond passive browsing.
Outbound booking/source clicks	Measures value delivered to organizers/platforms.
Fresh-event rate	Protects trust in the database.
Organizer submissions	Measures supply-side adoption.
Repeat weekend usage	Core signal that the product becomes a habit.

STARTING LANGUAGE

15. Brand Copy

Primary line

“Everything happening in Kolkata, this weekend.”

Alternative lines

- “Don’t ask what’s happening. We already found it.”
- “Your weekend starts here.”
- “Find something worth going out for.”
- “Kolkata has plans. We found them.”

ONE-SENTENCE VERSION

16. Final Product Definition

Kolkata This Weekend is a city-first discovery engine that collects and curates publicly available local events and experiences, helping people discover, save, share and act on the best things happening around Kolkata — without needing to own the events themselves.

The strategic principle

Own the discovery moment, not the event.
Let organizers keep their audiences, booking systems and channels. Kolkata This Weekend becomes the place people go first when they have free time and want to know what is worth doing.